INCH-POUND

A-A-55306A
May 26, 2026
SUPERSEDING
A-A-55306
January 29,1997

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

NEEDLE, SAILMAKER'S

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description (CID) by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This CID covers needles intended to be used by sailmakers for sewing and repairing canvas.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The sailmaker's needles will be of the following standard industry size numbers: 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, and 18.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Description. The sailmaker's needles shall be forged or cast steel. All needle surfaces, the eye, and the section of the eye adjacent to the heel shall be smooth and polished. Each needle shall be ground to a fine point. The edges of the triangle section shall be ground and rounded in such a manner that material fibers shall not be cut when pierced by the needle in the normal sewing operation. The eye shall be rounded and so designed that the thread will not be cut when used under ordinary service conditions. The opening of the eye shall be centered between its lateral surfaces. Needles shall be heat treated to meet deflection requirements without a permanent set. The needles shall conform to the dimensions listed in Table I.

3.1.1 Figures. Figure 1 is furnished as required methods of measuring and Figure 2 is furnished as required deflection testing. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written document and the figure, the written document shall govern.

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AMSC N/A FSC 8315

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TABLE I. Finished dimensions with tolerances (inches). **1/**

Needle size number	Over-all length A ± 3/16	B ± 5/16	C	D ± 1/8	E ± 0.005	F ± 0.011	G ± 0.007	H **2/** ± 0.0312
6	5-1/8	3-1/16	.201 ± .016	1-1/2	.189	.204	.138	.417
8	4-9/16	2-5/8	.169 ± .014	1-3/8	.156	.164	.117	.367
10	3-3/4	2	.138 ± .012	1	.127	.134	.097	.344
12	3-3/16	1-13/16	.108 ± .010	7/8	.102	.101	.077	.229
14	2-3/4	1-1/2	.085 ± .008	3/4	.078	.080	.060	.180
16	2-7/16	1-1/4	.068 ± .006	5/8	.063	.064	.047	.166
18	2-3/16	1-1/8	.052 ± .004	1/2	.046	.054	.035	.133

1/ See Figure 1 below
2/ Inside length of needle eye

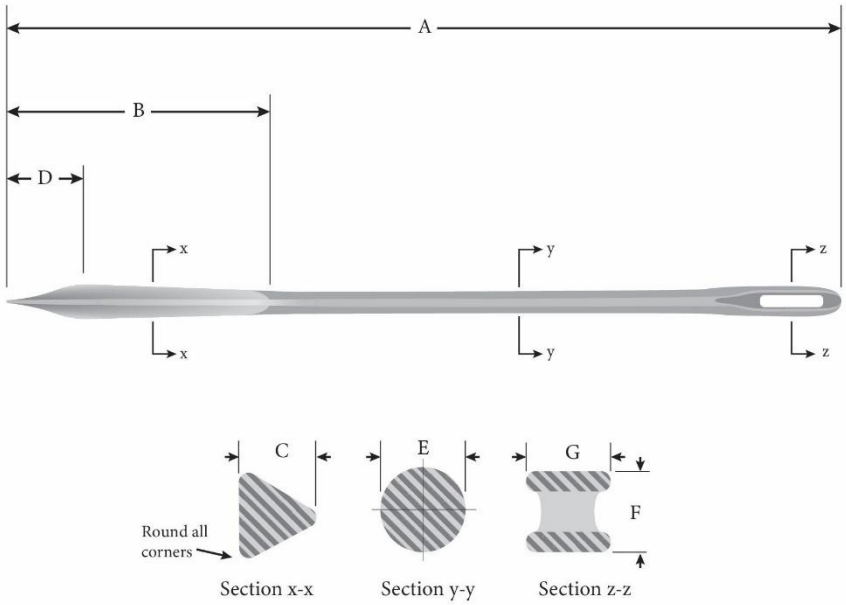


Figure 1. Sailmaker's Needles
For visual representation only, not drawn to scale

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3.2 Deflection test. The point end of the needle shall be placed between two pieces of 3/16-inch diameter drill rod, held rigidly by a vise as shown in Figure 2, or by a vise with V block, or by other means. The distances "s" and "d" are shown in Figure 2. The distance "s" between the drill rods shall be as shown in Table II. The tip of the needle shall extend 3/32-inch beyond the point of contact with the drill rod. When the needles are held by other than drill rods, they shall be gripped 7/32-inches maximum from the point of the needle. A force shall be applied to the eye end of the needle, as close as possible to the heel, in a direction that will cause the needle to bend while the point remains stationary. A relatively sharp-edged tool such as a screwdriver or chisel shall be used in applying this force. The heel of each needle shall be deflected a linear distance "d" as specified in Table II. This test shall be performed for each of the three planes represented by the triangular section of each needle. Any permanent set of the needle shall constitute failure of this test.

TABLE II. Distance and deflection (inches).

Needle number	Distance (s)	Distance (d)
6	7/16	9/16
8	7/16	9/16
10	7/16	9/16
12	3/8	5/8
14	3/8	9/16
16	3/8	9/16
18	5/16	9/16

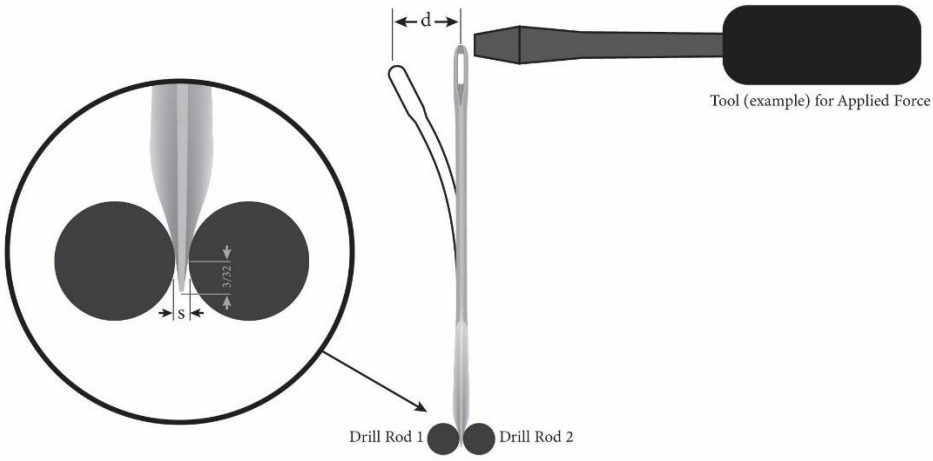


Figure 2. Deflection Test
For visual representation only, not drawn to scale

3.3 Workmanship. The finished sailmaker's needles shall conform to the quality of the product established in this document. The sailmaker's needs shall be free from defects which would affect its serviceability, appearance, uniformity and quality assurance standards defined by the technical data in the procurement documents.

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4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Unless otherwise specified, the offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered, recycled, bio based, and environmentally preferable materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403, 23.404(b) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR), or the sustainable acquisition of EO 13834; as applicable.

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The sailmaker's needle shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Market acceptability. The finished sailmaker's needles that are offered must have been sold to the government or commercial market.

5.3 End item inspection procedures. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection of Attributes (see 7.3.1).

5.4 Visual examination. Each finished sailmaker's needle shall be examined for the defects listed in Table IV as defined. The lot size shall be expressed in units. The sample unit shall be one (1) sailmaker's needle.

TABLE IV. Visual examination defects.

Material defects: Surface (including periphery of the eye) is not smooth; evidence of imbedded foreign matter; does not have fine, sharp point; edges of triangular section not ground and rounded; eye not centered between lateral edges; eye is partially or fully closed; sharp edge at eye (inside or outside); burrs or slivers not removed; needle is cracked or broken; evidence of pit holes, nicks, or scratches.
Workmanship: Measurement of item not as specified, any dimension of item not as specified; design not as specified. Failure to meet product conformance; serviceability, reliability and quality of materials as defined by this document.
Packaging: Not packaged in accordance with the contract or procurement documents.

5.5 Dimensional examination. The finished sailmaker's needles shall conform to the dimensions specified in Table III when measured as stated. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one (1) sailmaker's needle.

5.6 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

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6. PACKAGING. The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Source of Government documents:

7.1.1 Copies of Government documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.

7.1.2 EPA information is available online at https://www.epa.gov and EO 13834 information is available online at https://www.fedcenter.gov.

7.1.3 Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) are available online at https://acquisition.gov.

7.2 Source of non-Government documents:

7.2.1 ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures are available online at https://asq.org.

7.3 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to previous issues due to the extensiveness of the changes. This CID is to be used in preference to GGG-N-202. There is no NSN assignment for Size 17 and therefore, it has been deleted.

7.4 Intended use. The needles are intended to be used by sailmakers for sewing and repairing canvas.

7.5 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this CID.
b. Size required (see 2.).
c Product conformance (see 5.1).
d. Acceptance criteria (see 5.6).
e. Packaging requirements (see 6.).

7.6 National Stock Number (NSNs). The following is a list of NSNs assigned that correspond to this CID. This list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with the CID and are provided for reference only.

NSN	Size
8315-00-241-2871	6
8315-00-241-2872	8
8315-00-163-1545	10
8315-00-223-6860	12
8315-00-163-1547	14
8315-00-163-1551	16
8315-00-163-1544	18

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7.7 Key words.

Canvas
Repairing
Sewing

MILITARY INTERESTS:

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:
GSA-FAS

Custodians:
Army – GL
Navy – NU

Preparing activity:
DLA-CT

Review activities:
Navy – CG1, MC

(Project: 8315-2026-001)

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